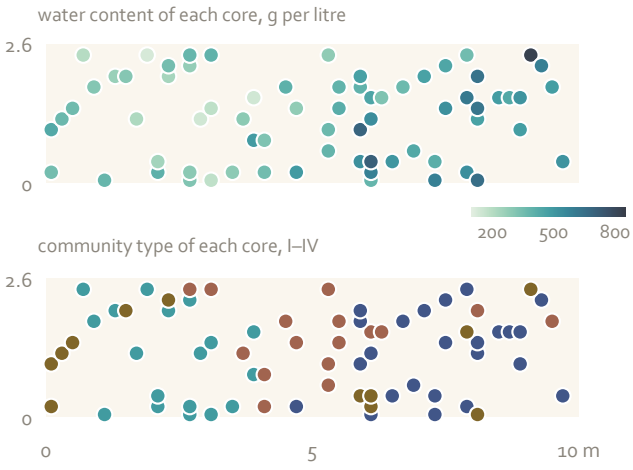
Habitat explains 44 % of the mite community, but 77 % of that is shared with space

Oribatid mites in 70 cores of Sphagnum peat, 35 species, 10 × 2.6 m · four community types (I–IV, by rising water content) in the same colours in every panel

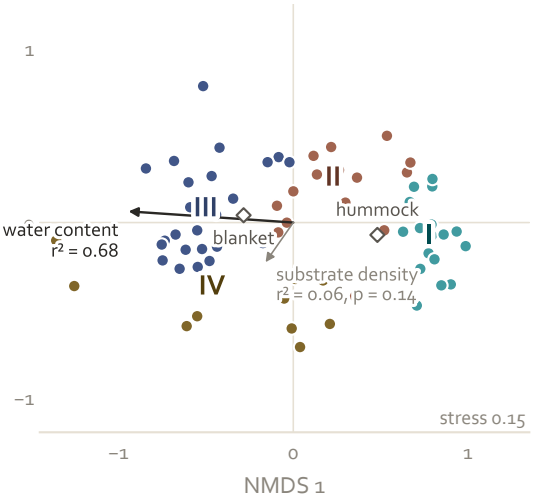
a Wet and dry patches carry their own fauna



type	mostly	water	cores
I	hummock, many shrubs	263	18
II	blanket, many shrubs	387	16
III	blanket, no shrubs	489	24
IV	blanket, few shrubs	508	12

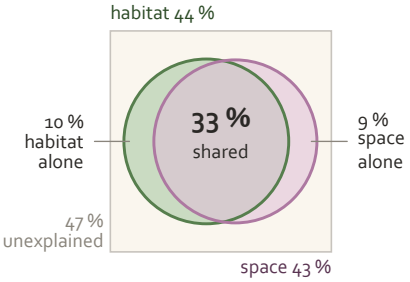
b Water content runs along the first axis, $r^2 = 0.68$

NMDS 2 · ◇ centroids of the two topographies

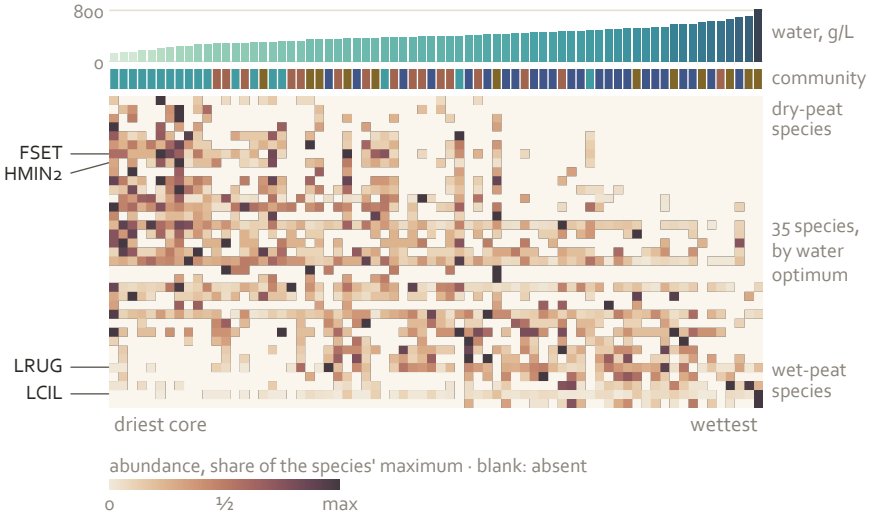


c Most explained variation is shared

square: all variation · areas: adjusted R^2

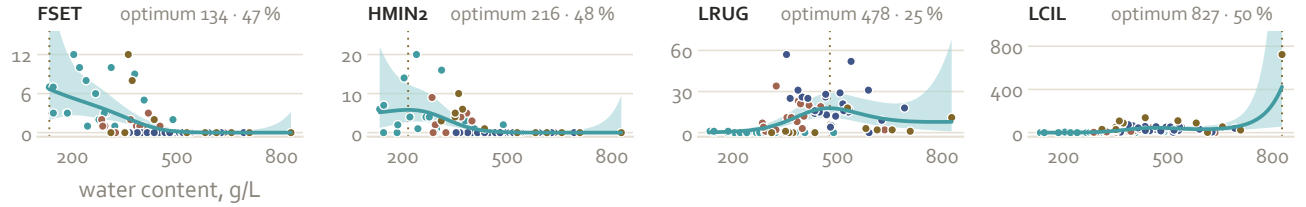


d Species replace one another along the water gradient



e Four species, four optima along the water gradient

individuals per core · line: negative-binomial GAM, 95 % band · dots coloured by community · dotted: optimum, g/L · %: deviance explained



Data: oribatid mites of Lac Geai bog, Québec, 70 cores (Borcard and Legendre 1994), via R vegan::mite, mite.env, mite.xy · mite_metacommunity.py · git 4c16514